

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024

INDIAN SOCIETY – 1

SOCIETY NOTES:

What is Society:

- A network of social relations based on patterns of interaction among the members is referred to as a society.

Why study society:

- To develop a perspective on the Indian Social System.
- To sensitize the governments/public officials on discourses of Society.
- To apply best practices of governance in the eradication of social problems.

Salient means unique character

1. Patriarchy.
2. Caste system.
3. Stratification.
4. **Diversity:** Linguistic diversity (Diversity can create problems like) (linguistic Nationalism), Religious diversity (Communalism), Regional diversity (Regionalism), Ethnic diversity (Ethno nationalism), Racial diversity (Racial intolerance).
5. Unity in diversity.
6. Joint Family
7. Collectivism
8. Blend of tradition and modernity
9. Secularism: It arises due to a difference in the pace at which the tangible and non-tangible aspects of culture change. It is believed that social problems and conflicts are caused because of this lag.
10. Multi Culturalism

Multi-culturalism: It means exist peaceful coexistence of diverse cultures.

- India is a land of diverse cultures. There exist peaceful coexistence of diverse cultures. (Not only are we diverse but we have peaceful coexistence): Akhbar: Din Elahi, Buddhism, Hinduism, Jainism and others
- People tend to retain, celebrate and transmit or pass the culture from one generation to another.
- There are 2 schools of thought concerning multiculturalism, that is melting-pot and salad bowl.
- **Melting pot**-People of different cultures melt together deserting their cultures and getting **fully assimilated within the predominated society**.
- **Salad Bowl**-It describes a heterogeneous society where different cultures are brought together as the salad's ingredients. However, the **individual flavour is retained**. (Salad bowl can also be interpreted as integration) (India is an example of Salad Bowl concept of Multiculturalism. We have our individual culture yet we are bound by common political culture, Economic Culture, Social Culture)

Indian Society has changed from ancient time to present day era:

Ancient times:

1. **Hierarchical:** It refers to the ranking of members in social groups based on the power, influence, or dominance they exhibit, whereby some members are superior or subordinate to others. Example: Hierarchy in Caste, bureaucracy.
2. **Ritual status-** The status in society is determined on the basis of birth in a particular group. For example, status is based on gender (boy in patriarchal society enjoy better), (being a member of dominant caste)etc
3. **Varna Based Division:** It is a system which divides society into four social groups all over the country. It's a model of ritual and social hierarchy of caste system. Example: Four Varnas are Brahmin Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra; whereas caste are numerous which may or may not fit into these four varnas.
4. **Strong religious orientation:** Every aspect is governed by religion. Religion determines marriage, occupation. When religion is not only a matter of faith but it is a way of life and governs socio, economic, political and social aspect of life.
5. **Collectivism:** Social organization in which the individual is seen as being subordinate to a social collectivity such as a state, a nation, a race, or a social class.
6. **Particularism:** It is characterised by the saying, "You show me the man I show you the rule". Rules are not universal and depends on the person whom it has to be applied. Circumstances dictate how ideas and practices are applied. Some people are more equal than other
7. **Ashramas:** Another outstanding feature of the social organisation in ancient India was the Ashramas. It implied age in the journey of life with a view to prepare one-self for further journey: Bramhacharya, Grahastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa
8. **Freedom for women:** Woman could not lead a free life and she lived under the tutelage of her parents, her husband or her sons.

Changes in Indian Society being observed:

1. **Egalitarianism:** It is the principle that all people in a society have the same fundamental worth and should have equal civil, economic, and political rights. Example: Equal access to education and health care independent of place of birth or wealth. Usage: Egalitarianism, in every form and shape, is incompatible with the idea of private property.
2. **Secular status** (Socio Political economic secular status): Status in society is determined not on the basis of birth but by achievements. Status is achieved rather than acquired.
3. **Change in the use of religion:** Religion is not only a matter of faith but governs social, political, and economic cultures of life.
4. **Increase in rationality:** Decisions are being driven by scientific factors, logic, and facts. Things can be subjected to critical reasoning.
5. **Universalism:** Everyone is equal and treated the same i.e ideas and practises can be applied everywhere without modification. No matter who you are, you would be subjected to same rules.
6. **Egalitarianism:** It is the principle that all people in a society have the same fundamental worth and should have equal civil, economic, and political rights. Example: Equal access to education and health care independent of place of birth or wealth. Usage: Egalitarianism, in every form and shape, is incompatible with the idea of private property

Forces of change:

- Secular education
- Industrialization: This led to caste neutral jobs. Job was given to those who had skill rather than caste status.
- Urbanization: attitude undergoes change due to urbanism characterised by heterogeneity and anonymity. Eg: Movement via public transport, eating in public restaurant. This led to secular pattern of living.
- Equality.
- Rationality.
- Universalism.
- Printing Technology and spread of ideas at rapid pace.

The above forces of change were seen during British Rule. Therefore the general notion was that with the emergence of British Rule, India was getting modernised. But in reality, during British times, at max what occurred was mistaken modernity (Deepankar Gupta). We really witnessed Westernisation and not modernisation. M.N Srinivas gave these terms Westernisation (As India was under British Rule which is in west) and modernisation.

Westernisation and modernization:

- Westernization refers to a **blind imitation of the culture of the west**. (Giving up the old tradition)
- Whereas modernization refers to a **progressive transformation of social, political, economic, and attitudinal aspects of life**. Eg: Banning Triple Talaq, Abolition of untouchability
- The scope of westernization is limited to clothes, food habits, music preferences, etc.
- Whereas modernization (Giving up regressive ideas) is the fundamental concept that aims to bring about changes in values, attitudes, infrastructure, etc. For example industrialization, urbanization, the modern education system, etc.
- The extent of westernization is limited to the elite section of society (Upper and middle class: Not all can afford westernisation) however modernization is a mass affair that penetrates every section of society.
- Japan is modernised. They have modern technology but they have not given up on their tradition.

Observation:

- Westernisation per se is not wrong, however in the name of modernisation, restricting only to westernisation is wrong.
- Both Modernization and tradition can co-exist.
- Modernization is against only those values which are regressive

Some of the important institutions in Indian Society:**Family:**

- Family is defined as a social group consisting of people united by ties of blood, and marriage and adoption.

- Family performs the following functions: Common residence, Economic cooperation, Reproduction.
- **Joint Family:** When the family extends to 2 or more generations, it is known as a joint family.
- **Nuclear Family:** When the family extends to maximum 2 generations, it is known as nuclear family.

Features of Family in India:

- Patrilineal
- Patrilocal
- Common sharing of property: Ancestral property has not yet been divided.
- Commensality (Inter-dinning): Having food together and have common kitchen.
- Power is centralized in the hand of the oldest male member
- Common residence
- Age and gender are the main ordering principles of the family hierarchy. Oldest male member has maximum power and youngest female member has least power.

Functions of Family

- **Primary Socialisation:** Family plays an imp role in shaping personality of child. Family is the first school. Family inculcates values in child.
- **Agency of social control:** The elders in the joint family keep a check on the children and prevent them from performing a deviant act
- **Agency of social Insurance:** From each according to their ability to each according to need. In joint family, everyone is taken care of even if you are not earning, you are a child, PWD. Globalisation led to disintegration of joint families, which has impacted social insurance and vulnerability of old age population has increased.
- **Economic cooperation:** prevents fragmentation of assets and secures economy of expenditure.
- **Source of identity:** Family provides the emotional and social support which acts as basis for identity formation of an individual

Types of Family: Family can be divided on the basis of **marriage, residence, ancestry, composition**

1. **Marriage:** Monogamy (one wife and one husband), Polygamy (many wife and many husband) and Sologamy
 - a. **Monogamy Types: Straight Monogamy: All the life, there is only one partner even if the partner dies or divorce.** Concept of divorce and separation is not appreciated. Serial Monogamy (It means, one partner at a time but that does not mean there would be one partner throughout one's life)
Due to **globalisation (exchange of ideas, people)** there is decline of religion in socio importance. Secularisation: Social significance of religion has declined. The significance of religion in public sphere has declined. No longer, marriage is considered as sacred institution. Divorce and separation is no longer a taboo. People are going for remarriage and divorce. **Due to globalisation, there is secularisation and we are moving from straight monogamy to serial monogamy.**

- b. **Polygamy:** **Polygyny** means one husband and many wife and **Polyandry** means one wife and more than one husband. Polygyny is found in Islam. Polyandry is practised by **Khasa tribe of Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh** and **Toda tribe along Nilgiri Hills**
- c. **Sologamy:** It was in news in India due to the first case, it refers to self marriage that is act of self love. Although this marriage has no legal sanction, it is a symbolic ceremony to emphasise, self love and independence. **(Impact of Globalisation)**
- 2. **Residence:** Matrilocal (wife staying at her own place and husband visiting her. Matrilocal can be seen in Khasi, Nairs), Patrilocal (wife going to husband's place after marriage), Neo Local (New place of residence). **Due to globalisation, we are moving from patrilocal to neolocal.**
- 3. **Ancestry:** Patrilineal (Tracing the lineage from your father's side) and Matrilineal. In India, we have mostly in patrilineal families.
 - a. **Patrilineal:** It means the male lineage system in which there is a transfer of rights, property, surname, and wealth from father to coming generations. Example: Mostly it has been seen that an offspring irrespective of gender takes his father's surname.
 - b. **Matrilineal:** a social system where lineage is traced through woman. It is seen in Khasi tribe and Nairs.
- 4. **Composition:** Joint and Nuclear.
 - a. **Nuclear Family:** When the family extends to maximum 2 generations, it is known as nuclear family.
 - b. **Joint Family:** When the family extends to 2 or more generations, it is known as a joint family.

Joint Family:

- When the family extends to 2 or more generations, it is known as a joint family.
- **Issues in Joint Family:**
 - **Lack of privacy:**
 - **Lack of individualism** as joint family is characterised by collectivism.
 - **Low status of women:** Age and gender are the main ordering principles of the family hierarchy.
 - **High fertility rate as compared to nuclear family** as cost of bearing and rearing a child is not too much
 - **Disguised unemployment** as nearly all members are involved in family business without much focus on productivity, need of labour etc
 - **Self-alienation:** In a joint family, members are interacted on the basis of set norms and expectations of family rather than being as natural self. Self-alienation refers to detachment from oneself. Family is considered as a nexus where each member is concerned about what others are thinking, feeling, or doing. This nexus demands mutual concern and attention. It is believed that this process restricts the development of the self and results in alienation.
 - **Us vs Them:** The members of the joint family live in a family ghetto and they see the world in terms of Us vs Them. Ghetto is an area that is populated largely by members of a particular community and ghettoization is the process that leads to it. It can be due to social, cultural, and economic reasons.

- **Arena of conflict and contradiction:** The value system of joint family is not in sync with present day changes like each other like cooperation vs competition, collectiveness vs individualism, delayed gratification vs immediate gratification.
- **Reproduction of social labour:** In a joint family set up, children learn to conform and submit to authority. Hence, it leads to creation of submissive workforce. It is called as reproduction of social labour.

Impact of Globalisation on Joint Family

1. **Change in role of family as primary socialisation:** Disintegration of joint family has led to setback in value socialisation and primary socialisation has become a challenge. This can lead to decline of moral fabric. Globalisation, penetration of internet, increase in cost of living (parents are busy to fulfil economic needs to family
2. **Change in structure-** The disintegration of the Joint family. New forms of family are emerging like: Live In, Single Parent Family. Due to disintegration, there is decline in social support and increase in vulnerability of old age, youth, adolescence, the person with a disability, etc.
3. **Modification of interpersonal Relation:** Due to globalisation, Democratic decision making (age and gender are not the only parameters to have a say in decision making) and the status of women is improving. Due to social media, ties with family members improving.
4. **Change in educative role of family:** In the ancient times, the skill were imparted by the family members (artisanal skills etc.), later due to globalisation and emergence of specialised system of education, emergence of diverse job opportunities. So educative role of family has declined.
5. **Role of Spouse Selection:** The emergence of technology and media has reduced the role of the family in spouse selection.

However, the role of primary socialization and agency of social control(adult personality stabilization: do not commit deviant activity in adulthood) is still performed by joint family.

Emergent forms of the family

1. **Nuclear family with extended ties:** When the family extends to maximum 2 generations, it is known as nuclear family. In Nuclear family, marital relation are more important than blood relation.
2. **Single Parent Family** emerging due to Globalization, Secularisation: Marriage is seen no more as a sacred institution and Divorce is no more a taboo, Feminization of old age (women tend to live longer than man so more number of female in old age as compared to male; Census 2011: Sex Ratio=943/100 males but sex ratio in old age as per census 2011: 1033/1000 males), Economic independence of women.
3. **Female-headed Household:** same points as for heading 2
4. **Co habitation or Live-in :** It is emerging as a threat to the institution of marriage as due to legal stringency and social stigma people don't want to go through the divorce process
5. **Conjugal symmetrical family:** Both husband and wife has same power of negotiation and equal status in marital relation

UPSC QUESTION:

Q) Child cuddling is now being replaced by mobile phones. Discuss its impact on socialization of children. (10 marks; CSE-2023)

Q) Do you think marriage as a sacrament is losing its value in Modern India? (10 marks; CSE-2023)

Q) "Institution of joint family is characterised by both continuity and change." Discuss the statement **in the context of impact of globalisation on Indian Society**.

Q) The life cycle of a joint family depends on economic factors rather than social values. Discuss. (10 marks; CSE-2014)

Space for Answer:

CASTE SYSTEM:

Caste System:

- **Concept of the Caste system:** It refers to a system of social stratification based on the notion of purity and pollution. Caste system consists of hierarchically arranged, **closed** - **endogamous strata** where membership is ascriptive, contact is restricted and mobility is theoretically impossible (practically can happen)

- **Stratification:** It refers to the ranking of the group in a hierarchy based on the unequal distribution of societal rewards such as Social, Political, and Economic.

Features of the caste system-

- Innate nature: You born and die in the same caste
- Hierarchy
- Endogamy
- Separation of contact
- Commensality: (You are not allowed to inter-dine with people belonging to lower caste)
- Occupational division of labour- Occupation is predetermined by birth and every caste is supposed to treat their occupation as religious duty
- Disability and Privileges: caste system is a privilege for some and acts as disability for others
- Caste councils: To ensure that caste rules are strictly observed. Objective is to maintain purity of the caste and secure the uniformity of rules.

Transformation of the caste system-

Traditional	Forces of change	Contemporary Reality
i)Hierarchy ii)Separation of contact iii)Occupational division Based on purity and pollution	i)Industrialization ii)Urbanization iii)Modern value system iv)Role of state- a)Reservation- b)Land reforms c)Mandal commission	i)Caste-neutral job opportunities challenges the division of labour ii)Urbanisation offers heterogeneity & Anonymity leads Secular pattern of living. It challenges the notion of separation of contact. iii)Modern Value system like Rationality challenges notion of hierarchy based on pollution and purity.

Use the template: Traditional, Forces of change and contemporary changes in joint family, marriage etc. to write answers.

Role of state as force of change:

Reservation:

- With the reservation policy, the lower caste people got access to higher education, govt jobs, and political participation thereby improving their socio- economic and political status (i.e secular status) in the society
- However, the opportunities were not equally reaped by all which led to the emergence of class within the caste (Elitism)

CLASS WITHIN CASTE (ELITE

CASTE

Land Reforms:

With the emergence of land reforms there emerged a section who irrespective of their status in the traditional caste hierarchy became socially dominant due to land ownership, numerical strength, and political power. They are referred to as dominant caste.

Mandal commission:

With implementation of Mandal commission, there was an alteration in caste structure where instead of vertical arrangement with stigma, there was a horizontal competition for backwardness without any stigma. Caste has been dislodged from the ritual domain however has entered the psyche of the people during electoral politics.

Role of caste in politics: When the strategies to rule is based on caste, it is referred to as the role of caste in politics

Emergence:

1)Pre-independence-

- Christian missionaries spread the message of Christianity as a reformatory movement against regressive practices like caste. Eg: Language +English education
- This lead to emergence of the educated elite group who questioned certain practices eg: Caste system etc.

2)Post-independence-

- The opportunities wrt education, and jobs during the British period were largely availed by the **upper caste hence their position** got consolidated in the socio-political-economic-cultural domain hence they came to be known as the **entrenched caste**
- In the **post-independence period**, with land reforms there was the emergence of ascendant caste/ Dominant Caste (**seen before who now has political power**)

Post Independence:

Ist Phase (50's to 60's)

- Reflects the struggle between entrenched(ES) and ascendent(AS) caste for power

IInd Phase (1960's to 80's): Politicisation of caste

- It was characterized by the mobilization of lower caste people on caste lines both by both ES and AS to strengthen their vote bank. (Separation of contact is being done away with). This is referred to as the politicization of caste

IIIrd Phase-

- It was predicted that with secular education, caste neutral job and formation of multi-caste alliances the rigid caste identities will cease to exist. But caste has not cease to exist but what we witnessed in was **casteization of politics** that is the **emergence of caste-based political parties**.
- When politicians are mobilising the masses on the basis of the caste interest so as to seek their vote and to strengthen you vote bank this is called as **politicization of caste**. When politician are playing politics on the basis of the caste, the member of the cabinet is determined on the basis of the caste, who would get the ticket depends depending on the caste, while asking for votes politician are not asking the votes on the basis of other issues but on the basis of Caste or community and when politics is played by linking the caste interest it is called as **politicization of caste**.

- But then what happened people of some caste realised that people are using them for the vote banks and they are limiting their interest to only at the time of election. People formed caste based political parties to fulfil their caste interest. This is casteization of politics.

Contemporary reality of caste:

Data

- According to NFHS, only 12% of marriages are intercaste
- According to Bezwada Wilson, from 2016 to 2020, 472 deaths by manual scavengers has been recorded. This is official data. As per, Manual Scavenging prohibition act 2013, it is absolutely not allowed to recruit human for the work of manual scavenging and no toilet can be unsanitary. It implies still manual scavenging practise prevails. This is done by people belonging to lower caste.
- Despite the 2013 Act, recent govt survey by the Ministry of social justice and empowerment, there are **66692 manual scavengers in India**

Social and economic Indicators-

- According to the All India survey for higher education, GER=27.1 , GER(SC)=23.4. It is less than national average. GER- Gross enrolment ratio
- There exist social associations based on caste: **Caste-based matrimony**. Marriage is still governed by caste. There exist **educational society based on caste**. Eg: **Dalit Sahitya, Vaishya education society**.
- Economic Associations: DICCI, National Scheduled Caste Finance and Development Association etc.

Caste system in Rural and Urban areas:

In rural areas, core areas which had lot of resources were occupied by people belonging to upper caste and areas of periphery were occupied by the people belonging to lower caste. So people belonging to lower caste had lack of access to resources and lack of opportunity. So people migrate to urban areas as urban areas offered anonymity, heterogeneity, freedom and individualism. Urban areas were expected not be as discriminatory as the rural areas. However, people belonging to lower caste could not learn requisite skills and education in rural areas and were denied jobs on the basis of lack of skills. People of lower caste could not afford living in the expensive urban areas and were confined to informal sector.

Some Facts:

- According to the **study** conducted by **Amit Thorat** and **Omkar Joshi**, **30%** of Urban households are practising **untouchability**.
- According to **Satish Deshpande**, **untouchability** is practised through **Ghettoization (certain regions are inhabited by lower caste)** and separate utensils for serving foods & water, denial of room on rent to people of lower caste
- According to **ActionAid NGO**, In more than **25%** of villages, lower caste people are **not** allowed to work on the agricultural land as casual labour and also **suffer** from **wage discrimination**.
- Since there are **strict rules** with respect to the **exchange** of food and water, people of upper caste were **not** purchasing the food products from the hawkers of lower caste.

UPSC QUESTION:

- Why is caste identity in India both fluid and static? (15 marks; CSE-2023)
- Has caste lost its relevance in understanding Indian society? Elaborate your answers with illustrations. (10 marks; CSE-2020)
- The caste system is assuming new identities and associational forms. Hence it can not be eradicated in India. Comment. (12.5 marks; CSE-2015)
- Debate the issue whether and how contemporary movements for assertion of Dalit identity work towards annihilation of caste. (12.5 marks; CSE-2015)

Reservation:

Concept of reservation: Reservation policy refers to a form of affirmative action whereby the percentage of seats is reserved for the people belonging to socially and educationally backward communities.

Rationale of reservation:

- It was introduced to ensure the equality of opportunity, correct the historical injustice and give effect to the redistributive agenda of the state.

Arguments in favour of reservation:

- **Meritocracy** is meaningless without equality of opportunity.
- Political necessity to give **representation to every section**.
- It will provide an opportunity for **upward mobility**.
- It will **reduce** the gap between **have's** and **have not's**.
- It **prevents social conflicts** and will **promote national cohesion**.
- Helps in breaking stereotypes with respect to people.
- Development of "**cultural capital**". (**Cultural capital: social assets which creates opportunity for social mobility. Eg: Education, skill development, Health etc**)
- Better probability to reap benefits of demographic dividend.
- Women empowerment.
- Helps in achieving "**Substantive equality**". (Equity) (There are 2 type of equality: Formal Equality (Equality) and substantive equality (Equity)): Formal equality, which is a belief that, for fairness, people must be consistently or equally treated at all times. Substantive equality, which goes beyond the basics of recognizing the equality of everyone and identifies differences among groups of people with the long-term goal of greater understanding
- Ensure **diversity in higher education and jobs**.
- It ensures the transition from the **informal** to the **formal** labour market.

Arguments against reservation :

- Merit gets compromised.
- Not every section gets representation. Reservation has lead to class within the caste.
- Upward mobility is restricted to few.
- Skewed distribution of benefits (inter-caste; intra-caste). Benefits are not reaped by all.

- **There is a perspective of reverse discrimination due to reservation:** It refers to the discrimination against members of a dominant group in the favour of minorities or the disadvantaged.
- Violence against people from the reserved category has increased.
- It further consolidates the caste identities. Casteization of politics.
- It creates a perverse (negative) incentive for others to claim reservation and backwardness.
- It disincentives potential candidates from non-reserved categories and it leads to the situation of brain drain
- It further reinforces the stereotypes and aggravates the prejudiced/bias towards people availing reservation.
- Feeling of relative deprivation.

Way forward:

- New social yardsticks to determine reservation. Eg: As per **NALSA judgement 2014**, transgenders should be given reservation **under OBC status**. (NALSA judgement 2014, mentioned transgender are most deprived section of society as they are shunned by the families too)
- **De-reservation on the basis of social mapping: M Nagaraj case and Zernail case**, in both the cases the SC, has asked to introduce a creamy layer within SCs and STs. Since data is the new oil, credibility can be added via data
- **Capability** (human capital formation: accumulation of knowledge, skill, health over a period of time) **approach** of Amartya Sen should be the aim for social mobility.
- Overhauling of the **education system** (Include RTE in secondary education as well: Secondary education should be made free and compulsory to reduce drop out); quality of education of government schools should be at par with private schools.
- **Robust administrative system** is to ensure the penetration of reservation benefits for different sections. It can be awareness and making the administration accountable.
- **Encourage the culture of entrepreneurship** where youth is transformed from 'job seeker to job giver': START UP INDIA
- **Make agriculture lucrative: M S Swaminathan** says "the future belongs to a nation with grains rather than a gun". All complete the pending agricultural reforms.

Dalit Capitalism:

- Concept
- Who coined the term
- Is it Panacea for Dalit Problems

Concept:

- When capitalism is seen as a tool for the emancipation of Dalits, it is referred to as "**Dalit capitalism**". In simple words, entrepreneurship and self-employment among Dalits are referred to as **Dalit capitalism**. The term has been coined by social activists **Chandrabhan Prasad**.
- It creates an **opportunity** for economic empowerment of Dalits and results in their upward social mobility. The **government** is also promoting "Dalit Capitalism". **Eg:** DICCI, NSCFDC.

- However, it might be one of the means for emancipation, however, it does not guarantee their empowerment due to the **following reasons**:
 1. It does not change the existing social mindset with respect to caste rigidities
 2. Due to the restrictions with respect to opportunities, they may lack the cultural capital and hence not be able to reap the benefits of Dalit capitalism. Hence, the benefits will only be reaped by those who are already elite within the Dalit community which will further aggravate the divide.
 3. It might create a situation where Dalit capitalists may have to confront various challenges with respect to social and administrative and economic domain. For eg: Discriminatory attitude in accessing loan from banks. This can be one of the solution but can't guarantee emancipation till the time attitudinal change is ensured.
 4. It still lacks in ensuring the upliftment of the poorest of poor as it does not focus on self-respect, social exclusion, land alienation, etc.

Violence against Dalit:

Q) Despite stringent legal provisions, violence against Dalit is on rise. Discuss.

- **Data:** According to the **NCRB, 2020**; there was a **9.5%** rise in violence against Dalits.

Why on rise:

- Lack of awareness about the legal safeguards. **Eg:** Prevention of Atrocities Act.
- Persistence of a rigid caste system despite the efforts of the government to eradicate its discriminatory component.
- Lack of adequate representation of Dalits within administration and law enforcement agencies.
- Lack of reporting by Dalits since their livelihood depends upon the upper castes.
- According to **Christopher Jefferlot**, the increased status of Dalits with respect to secular hierarchy acts as a threat to the hegemony of the forward caste which results in the feeling of deprivation leading to violence.
- Lack of strict implementation of existing provisions and poor conviction rate. According to NCRB in 2020, out of 50216 cases, only 216 conviction rate was reported.
- The pendency case was very high. In one of largest state in India, out of 49000 case only 55 cases were tried. (Pendency rate is almost-99%). Administrative issues/ Systemic issues / Red tapism / Pendency of the cases: Delay in Justice: Justice delayed is justice denied
- The process of Sanskritization when challenged by the upper/forward castes, it also results in violence against Dalits.
- Many do not report the act of discrimination as there is a lack of subjective realisation of objective reality and consider it as a matter of fate.
- There is a fear of retaliation.
- According to the **apex court**, there have been incidences where the **existing laws** like POA Act have been missed and the **term was coined new legal terrorism** where instead of these provisions as a shield they were used as a weapon to settle personal agenda/scores.

- Rigid rules with respect to caste endogamy when breached result in honour killing/violence.
- **Glorification of fringe elements** (fringe elements here means those people who have slightly different and extreme ideology than majority. It can also be notorious element) by political parties also reduces the deterrence factor

Sanskritization:

Sanskritization : when lower caste people emulate culture of upper caste to improve their status. The upper caste does not like the process the Sanskritization. When a person from lower caste tries to ride a horse in marriage procession that he is being attacked. When they try to keep a moustache they are being attacked because it is believed it is the culture of upper caste and should not be emulated by the lower caste. This leads to violence against lower caste.